



Client Portal — review & trial week

CF Building Approvals — internal

Tuesday 4 August 2026 ·

· Kacie, Chris, Rebecca, Fiona · Allow 85 minutes

The portal is live and doing real work. This session walks the whole thing through together — what the client sees, what it changes on the board, and where the autogen fits — and then puts it in your hands for the week, so we find the rough edges before our clients do.

What we want out of this week: everyone has used the portal as a client and as staff at least once, and anything that felt wrong, slow or confusing is written down. Finding ten small problems now is worth far more than a tidy meeting.

RUNNING ORDER

5 min	Where we're up to What's live, what's still coming, what we're deciding this week.	Chris
15 min	The client's side Signing in, the dashboard, lodging a job, messages, downloads, resources. What they can see and — just as important — what they can't.	Chris
20 min	One job, start to finish A single job walked the whole way through on screen: lodged, onto the board, assessed, issued, downloaded. Stop me anywhere. Page 2	All
10 min	An FIR, worked through The part that saves us the most time, and the part most likely to catch us out. Page 2	Chris
10 min	Amendments — this one has changed They no longer go on the board at all. Affects Kacie, Chris and Rebecca directly. Page 3	All
10 min	The admin dashboard Queue, Clients, Enquiries, Content, Settings. Issuing a login. The 5pm report and what it's actually for.	Chris
10 min	Monday and the CDC autogen What's automatic now, what the PORTAL column is telling you, and what still needs a person. Page 4	Chris
5 min	Your trial this week Who's doing what, and how to tell me what you find. Page 4	All

ONE JOB, START TO FINISH

- 1

Client lodges through the portal Client

Address, class, description and plans. The Monday card is created **straight away** — client, email, class and description filled in, and their PDFs in the Files column. No re-typing.
- 2

Reference, folders, assign Kacie

As always — but the card arrives populated, so it's checking rather than creating.
- 3

Assessment Chris Rebecca

Unchanged. Where information is missing, that's an FIR — below.
- 4

To CDC — the autogen produces the certificate Automatic

It writes the Word document. **We still check it and PDF it ourselves** — nothing goes out that a person hasn't read.
- 5

Status → Issued Kacie

The one action that starts delivery. PORTAL moves to **ISSUED** — we have it in hand, the client has nothing yet.
- 6

The portal collects the files and emails the client Automatic

SharePoint is checked **every five minutes**. When the package is there the client is emailed and PORTAL moves to **READY**.
- 7

Client downloads Client

PORTAL moves to **DOWNLOADED** and a receipt is posted on the card. The end of “did you get it?” phone calls.

AN FIR, WORKED THROUGH

- 1

Set the status to FIR and send the message from the portal

The client gets an email and sees the request against that job — not buried in a thread with the rest of their work.
- 2

The client replies with the missing document

Their reply and their file land on the card as an update, and the status moves itself to **New Info Received**. That automatic move is the point: an answered job stops sitting in the FIR group looking like it's still waiting on them.
- 3

You get told

An email to the office with the reply and the attachment on it, so you can see what came back without opening anything.

Watch this one on Tuesday. If a status doesn't move itself, or a reply doesn't reach the board, say so straight away — a job that goes quiet here is the failure that costs a client a week.

AMENDMENTS — WHAT'S CHANGED

A client changing their mind, or a council asking them to. These used to open a **new job on the board**, where they sat looking like an assessment for days — when the real work is checking it, watermarking the drawings and re-issuing. They don't go on the board any more.

1

The client lodges it in the portal

Client

They pick the job — including ones we finished years ago — say what's changed and attach the new drawings.

2

It emails whoever certified it

Automatic

Straight to Chris or Rebecca off the board's **Certified By** column, with the office copied, carrying the reason and the documents. Nobody in that column means it goes to Rebecca.

3

You reply “yes” by email

Rebecca

Chris

Exactly as you do today. No system, no button, nothing to learn.

4

Watermark and re-issue, then upload it back

Kacie

The only new step for anyone: the revised CDC goes back through **Admin** → **Amendments**. With no card on the board there's no SharePoint sync to collect it.

5

The client is emailed and can download it

Automatic

Their original certificate stays valid until then, and both sit side by side.

WHAT THE BOARD SEES

One line on the **original** card saying an amendment was lodged, who it went to, and that the certificate is unchanged until a revised one is issued. No new item, no status, nothing to work through. A second line when the revised one goes out.

The catch to watch for. Because they're off the board, the board can't notice one going quiet. The 5pm report does instead — an amendment nobody has answered appears there, and so does one whose email failed to send. If you get an amendment email and it isn't yours, say so rather than leaving it.

WHAT'S AUTOMATIC NOW

Card creation	The moment a client lodges. Nothing to re-type.
Files onto the card	Their plans go straight into the Files column.
Status on a reply	FIR → New Info Received when the client answers.
Amendments	Never on the board — see page 3.
Delivery	Checked every 5 minutes; client emailed when it lands.
PORTAL column	ISSUED → READY → DOWNLOADED, so the board shows where a certificate actually is. STUCK means it hasn't got there and somebody needs to look.
Download receipt	On the card the first time they open it.
5pm report	Weekdays. Anything that should have reached a client and didn't.
Still a person	Checking the autogen's Word document, PDF-ing it, and setting the status to Issued.

YOUR TRIAL THIS WEEK

You each get a client login too. Please get through this by **Friday**, on a test job rather than a live one.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Sign in for the first time with the code you're emailed | ☐ Download a package and open the zip |
| ☐ Set your own password, then sign out and back in | ☐ Send a general enquiry — not about a job |
| ☐ Lodge a job with plans attached | ☐ Try it on your phone, not just the desktop |
| ☐ Check it appeared on the board correctly | ☐ Look at Resources — forms, wind and bushfire checkers |
| ☐ Send a message about a job | ☐ Try to break it. Wrong password, huge file, odd address |
| ☐ Answer an FIR and attach a document | ☐ Reset your password and get back in |
| ☐ Lodge an amendment, including on a completed job | |

HOW TO TELL ME WHAT YOU FIND

Something's broken	Tell me the same day — don't wait for Friday.
Something's clumsy	Write it down as you go — you won't remember later.
Wording that's wrong	Especially anything a client reads.
What to include	What you did, what you expected, what happened.

Friday: fifteen minutes on what everyone found, and what's worth fixing before the first client sees it. Small things are welcome — they're the difference between a portal clients use and one they ignore.

WHAT A CLIENT CAN DO

Their sidebar, top to bottom. Anything here can be switched off from Settings while we update it, without taking the portal down.

Dashboard	Every one of their jobs and what stage it's at, on one screen.
My Jobs	One job in detail — the stage timeline, who's assessing it, and how long it's been with us.
My Messages	A thread per job, newest first. Attachments both ways. This is where an FIR is answered.
Lodge a Job	Address, class, description and PDFs — plus anything they've saved in My Details. Straight onto the board.
Amend a Job	A change to any job we've done for them — current or long finished. Goes by email to whoever certified it, never onto the board.
Downloads	Every package we've issued them, downloadable again as often as they like.
Info Sheets	The fourteen guidance notes.
Resources	Council forms, the wind classification checker, the bushfire map check, maps and property links, and all thirty councils with their lodgement pages.
Site Plan Tool	Draws a compliant site plan for a simple job, rather than us sending it back for one.
Engineering	The engineering checker. Hidden until we switch it on.
My Details	Their contact details, and a library of documents they reuse job to job.
Help & Support	How the portal works, and a general enquiry that reaches us even when it isn't about a job.

AND AROUND THE EDGES

- First sign-in with a one-time code, then they set their own password
- Password reset without losing their username
- Unread counts against jobs and messages
- Cancel a job they've lodged
- Export their job list
- Works on a phone — most of them will lodge from site

WHAT WE CAN DO

Queue	Lodgements waiting to be accepted. Normally empty — a job goes straight onto the board. Anything sitting here means Monday was down when they pressed Lodge.
Clients	The registry. Issue a login, email the details and one-time code, reset a password, check their SharePoint folder resolves, view the portal as them, remove a client.
Enquiries	Questions with no job behind them, and the reply goes back through the portal.
Amendments	Every amendment lodged, who it went to and why, and where the revised certificate goes back out from.
Content	Info sheets, council forms and engineering sets — upload a new version any time without a redeploy.
Settings	What's connected, the evening report, Teams notifications, switching client pages on and off.
Turnaround Reports	How long jobs are taking, by class, with the days a job spent waiting on the client taken out.
Activity Log	Who did what, and when.
Sync Now	Don't wait five minutes.

WHAT RUNS WITHOUT ANYONE

Every 5 minutes	Collects issued packages, emails clients, refreshes job status, delivers messages, moves the PORTAL column.
On a lodgement	Monday card created, files attached, client acknowledged.
On a client reply	Posted to the card, status moved off FIR, office emailed, Teams notified.
On a download	Receipt on the card, PORTAL to DOWNLOADED, retention clock starts.
After 45 minutes	An issued job with no files is flagged STUCK .
After 3 days	A package that's ready and still unopened is chased.
5pm weekdays	The report: anything that should have reached a client and didn't — including an amendment nobody has answered.
Also at 5pm	Rebuilds each client's list of past jobs, so they can pick a finished one to amend.
Monday mornings	A digest to each client with anything outstanding.
On the retention date	Files purged automatically. Nothing sits forever.

The one thing to remember: the portal never decides anything. It moves files, tells people, and keeps the board honest about where a certificate actually is. Every judgement is still ours.